



The first Shinkansen trains ran at speeds of up to 130 mph (210 km/h). The latest classes of trains take their power from 25,000 volt overhead electricity lines and can reach a top speed of 200 mph (320 km/h). The trains run on their own lines, separate from slower rail traffic—a total of 1,483 miles (2,387 km) of high-speed track crosses Japan. As many as

13 bullet trains per hour fly between Japan's two biggest urban areas, Tokyo and Osaka, providing an unrivalled high-speed service. Before the bullet trains were introduced, journey time between the two cities was around 6 hours, 40 minutes. The fastest services today complete the route in just 2 hours, 35 minutes.